

PLANNING PHASE

1.Introduction

The Planning Phase is an essential stage in the development of the Laptop Request Management System. This phase focuses on defining the project scope, objectives, resources, timeline, and implementation strategy. Proper planning ensures that the project is completed within the specified time frame while meeting the functional and business requirements of the organization.

The primary goal of this project is to automate the laptop request process using ServiceNow by implementing Service Catalog, Flow Designer, Approval Management, Catalog Tasks, and Email Notifications. The planning phase helps identify the required activities and provides a roadmap for successful project execution.

2.Project Objectives

The main objectives of the project are:

- To automate the laptop request submission process.
- To implement an approval-based workflow for request validation.
- To reduce manual effort in handling requests.
- To create tasks automatically for the IT support team after approval.
- To provide email notifications regarding request status.
- To improve request tracking and transparency.

By achieving these objectives, the organization can streamline its laptop allocation process and enhance operational efficiency.

3.Project Scope

The scope of the Laptop Request Management System includes all activities related to requesting, approving, and fulfilling laptop requests within the organization.

In Scope

- Laptop Request Catalog Item creation.
- Employee request submission.
- Manager approval workflow.
- Automated Catalog Task creation.

- Approval and rejection notifications.
- Request tracking through ServiceNow.

Out of Scope

- Hardware inventory management.
- Procurement and vendor integration.
- Asset lifecycle management.
- Financial approval processes.

Defining the project scope helps ensure that development efforts remain focused on the core requirements.

4.Resource Planning

The successful implementation of the project requires both technical and human resources.

Software Resources

- ServiceNow Platform
- Service Catalog Module
- Flow Designer
- Approval Engine
- Email Notification Service
- Web Browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox)

Human Resources

System Administrator

Responsible for platform configuration and access management.

ServiceNow Developer

Responsible for creating catalog items, workflows, approvals, and notifications.

Approver/Manager

Responsible for reviewing and approving laptop requests.

End User

Responsible for submitting laptop requests through the Service Portal.

5. Risk Assessment and Mitigation

Several risks were identified during the planning phase.

Risk 1: Incorrect Approval Configuration

If approvers are not configured properly, requests may remain pending.

Mitigation:

Proper testing of approval rules before deployment.

Risk 2: Email Notification Failure

Users may not receive status updates.

Mitigation:

Verify email configurations and conduct notification testing.

Risk 3: Workflow Errors

Incorrect flow logic may interrupt the process.

Mitigation:

Perform flow validation and execution testing.

Risk 4: User Adoption Challenges

Employees may face difficulties using the new system.

Mitigation:

Provide user training and documentation.

6. Project Schedule

The project activities were divided into multiple stages to ensure systematic development.

Phase Activity

Week 1 Requirement Gathering and Analysis

Week 1 Project Planning

Week 2 Service Catalog Design

Week 2 Flow Designer Configuration

Phase Activity

Week 3 Approval Process Development

Week 3 Catalog Task Creation

Week 4 Email Notification Setup

Week 4 Testing and Validation

Week 5 Deployment and Documentation

This schedule provides a structured approach for completing the project on time.

7.Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

The project was divided into smaller tasks to simplify development and monitoring.

Phase 1: Requirement Analysis

- Gather business requirements.
- Identify stakeholders.
- Define project objectives.

Phase 2: Design

- Design workflow architecture.
- Design approval process.
- Design request form.

Phase 3: Development

- Create Service Catalog Item.
- Configure Flow Designer.
- Implement approval workflow.
- Configure notifications.

Phase 4: Testing

- Test request submission.
- Test approvals.
- Test task creation.

- Test notifications.

Phase 5: Deployment

- Activate workflow.
 - Deploy to production environment.
 - Monitor performance.
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8. Feasibility Analysis

Technical Feasibility

The project is technically feasible because ServiceNow provides built-in modules such as Service Catalog, Flow Designer, and Approval Management, which support workflow automation.

Operational Feasibility

The proposed system simplifies the request process and improves user experience, making it operationally feasible.

Economic Feasibility

The project minimizes manual effort and reduces administrative workload, resulting in cost savings and improved productivity.

9. Project Deliverables

The following deliverables were planned for the project:

- Laptop Request Catalog Item
- Automated Approval Workflow
- Catalog Task Creation Process
- Email Notification System
- Project Documentation
- Test Cases and Reports

These deliverables ensure successful implementation of the proposed solution.

10.Planning Outcome

The Planning Phase established a clear roadmap for developing the Laptop Request Management System in ServiceNow. The project objectives, scope, resources, risks, schedule, and deliverables were clearly identified and documented. Effective planning ensured that the project could be executed systematically while meeting organizational requirements and business goals.

The outcome of this phase provided a strong foundation for the subsequent design, development, testing, and deployment phases of the project.